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London League 2026 Rule Book 1

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London League 2026 Rule Book

All teams must abide by below rules.

Game Start times:

- Games will be 30 overs each innings.
- Games start times will be specified on the schedule.
- Umpire will conduct the toss 15mins prior to the match start.
- The first ball will be bowled at the allocated start time specified on the schedule.
 - This is a **TIME RESTRICTED EVENT**, games are expected to commence and end as per the schedule.
 - **Each 5 minute delayed start of the innings will result in 1 over deduction to the team that is causing the tardiness. Umpires will enforce the rule.**
 - A team that does not have a minimum of 7 playing members on the ground at scheduled start time, will be considered a late arrival and will receive a late arrival penalty mentioned above.
 - A team that receives two penalties will risk being removed from the league for the remainder of the season.
 - If a team does not have a minimum of 7 players on the ground by 15 minutes before the match start time, the opposing team claims the toss.
 - The Umpire will call off the game if there is a maximum of 30 minutes **delayed start** due to weather or other unforeseen circumstances.
 - Any player (including the super-sub) cannot be included in the game if he is over an hour late.
 - A bowler who is a late arrival must wait for the duration of the overs missed before he can bowl.
- There will be Two sets of breaks plus an innings break.
 - 1st break – after 15 overs – 5 minutes (water)
 - 2nd break – after 30 overs – 10 minutes (Innings Break)
 - 3rd break – after 15 overs (second innings) – 5 minutes (water).
 - On a hot day Umpires will decide if more water breaks are needed.
- Each innings should be finished within 2 hours 15 minutes **including the breaks**.
 - The following rules will apply
 - If the match is not on par with the allotted time for the innings after the 15th over, no side change can be permitted.

- The second innings will also abide by this rule.
- DLS Rule will be applied if the teams do not finish their innings within the allotted time.
 - DLS Rule will be implemented by the Umpires via the CricClubs App.
 - The second inning will start as scheduled with a revised DLS target.
- A bowler who exits the ground during the match for any valid reason and returns to the game must wait **to the equal number of overs spent outside** before he is allowed to bowl again.

Home Game rules:

- Each Home Team will need to prepare the ground 15 minutes prior to the toss.
 - Preparation includes bringing:
 - 2 sets of stumps and bails
 - Chalk for the marking on the pitch
 - Boundary markers.
 - League provided Match ball.
 - Prepping the 30 yards circle.

The Balls:

- The only ball allowed for all LCL matches will be the ball purchased from LCL. Any team not in compliance will forfeit the game.
 - 18x LCL branded balls will also be provided that will be used for all the games.
 - Each team must maintain at least 2 used balls during each match to replace when needed. i.e save time while searching for the lost ball.
 - If the ball is lost within the power play, a new league ball can be used to continue with the game
 - Exception to point 8 can only be made in the following scenarios
 - Lost ball.
 - Damaged-deteriorated ball.
 - Ball change will be approved by the umpire.

Fielding rules:

- Leg side rule: Only two fielders (excluding the wicket-keeper) are allowed behind the popping crease on the on side at the moment when the bowler delivers the ball. If more than two fielders are present, it will be considered a no ball, and the striker's end umpire will call and signal it.

Powerplay Rules:

- Overs 1-6 - Fielding restrictions: maximum 2 fielders outside the 30-yd circle.
- Powerplay 2: Overs 7-30 - Fielding restrictions: maximum 5 fielders outside the 30-yd circle.

Fair Delivery Rule:

- **Return crease** - the bowler's back foot must land within and not touching the return crease appertaining to his/her stated mode of delivery. (MCC 21.5.1)
- **Crease line** - the bowler's front foot must land with some part of the foot, whether grounded or raised on the same side of the drawn/imaginary line joining the two middle stumps as the return crease, and behind the popping crease. (MCC 21.5.2)

The league will supply umpires for each game:

- There will be One Umpire per game during the group stage.
- Umpires are **not allowed** to wear **White Uniform** – as we are playing with a White Ball
- Two umpires will be provided for the playoffs.

New Player Addition:

- Any new player in addition to the already submitted squad, that will join later in any team can play and register for the London League. The deadline to add new players is **June 30th**.

- Captains have the ability to add/remove players to their respective team roster. if you need assistance with adding a player to your team in cricclub, ensure you submit your request by Thursday of each week. Any request submitted after Thursday of each week, will be completed on the following Monday.
- Any player who is not officially registered in cricclub app or plays under false pretense including but not limited to using a false identity, or playing for a team without proper clearance will be subjected to an automatic suspension for the season.
- ~~The captain responsible for the above action will receive a three (3) match ban.~~
- ~~The opposing team will be awarded the match points.~~

Super Subs Rule:

- One Super Sub per game.
- Super Sub is only allowed to participate in one of the two innings.
- Super Subs will be announced by each team prior to the toss – before the match begins. These subs can only be chosen from the registered members submitted to the league.
- Playing 12(super-sub included) should be declared in the CricClubs app prior to the toss completion._
- Super Subs are allowed in every game for each team. These Subs can only play "One Innings" be it as a batsman or a bowler - they can, however, be used as a substitute fielder only in the case of injury or emergency, but are not allowed to bat or bowl, unless substituted for another player.
- ~~The above rule will be implanted when it is determined as a genuine case by the umpire.~~
- ~~Super Subs must be announced before the Toss, to both the Umpire and the opposing teams Captain as well.~~
- If a super sub leaves the ground for whatever reason and is found to participate in a cricket game elsewhere, the player will be suspended for 3 consecutive league games.

CricClubs ID rules:

- All players listed in CricClubs must include a photo, clearly showing their faces, as part of their profile. Uploading other objects, such as a picture of their pet or favorite car etc are not allowed.
- All players must upload a photo to CricClubs app by May 9th. Opposing captain/umpire can ask the player to leave the field if the player is not registered on Cricclubs app.
- Only final score summary update shall be requested from the admin. No individual correction will be made to a scorecard once the match has concluded.
 - All teams are required to ensure accurate score keeping during the match.
 - In the event of an abandoned match, the team list should be submitted to the league at the schedule start of the game via email. londonleagueboard@gmail.com
- ~~Failure to comply with point 2 will result in players match count not counted towards playoff qualification.~~

League Uniform:

- Each team needs to have proper jerseys / uniforms.
- No white pads allowed – please purchase covers for batting pads.
- ~~The Board has permitted each club to play with dark colored clothing until the team Jersey arrives, if their jerseys are not ready. A player who does not have their team jersey by the deadline is not permitted to participate in any game until the jersey arrives. Deadline for this compliance is June 30th.~~

Participation Rule:

- Each team must have a minimum of 15 members.
- Only those players who have played at least 50% plus 1 game in the league stage can participate in the playoffs.
- Minimum of 7 players must be on the field in the instance where all 11 are not available.
- No show on the 2nd time, by any team will result in an automatic elimination and will be banned from LCL for 1 year – Also, there will be no refunds on the season costs paid to the league.
 - Exceptions related to Covid, family emergencies, act of God.

- In case of rain, or if the game cannot be completed for any reason:
 - Points will be divided only if the match is abandoned before the first innings or if only the first innings has been completed.
 - Duckworth-Lewis rule will only be implemented if at least 7 overs have been bowled in the **second innings**.

Communication:

- Each team executive member/captain can communicate with the league via emailing londonleagueboard@gmail.com with their concerns or inquiries.

Probation period:

- The Board / League maintains the right to eliminate any club / team in their first year, with **just cause**. Hence a year probation will be practiced for all new entrants to the league.

Release of player:

- Each player will be required to submit a letter of “NOC” from their current club if they want to switch clubs within the season:
 - **June 30th will be the deadline for this action.**
- **The above also applies to players switching teams within a club.**
- **This switch can only be made once per season.**
- If any player wishes to exit their current club, he requires an NOC from his current club that has to be presented to the team he is joining 60 days prior to the start of the upcoming season.

Misbehaviour:

- Umpires are authorized to give **One Warning** to any player(s) involved in misbehaving.
- If the behaviour persists, Umpires are authorized to **discontinue that player’s game** and **ban him for the next game**.
 - In that instance – a twelfth man or the super-sub can be brought on to the field.
 - In case of a super-sub brought in, the super-sub rule applies.
- If any player or spectator is guilty of physically abusing an umpire, the guilty party will face an automatic suspension for the remainder of the match and season.
 - Future participation of player(s) involved in an incident mentioned above will be reviewed by the board and the board will announce its decision on the player whether future participation will be permitted.
- Influencing or calling on the leg umpire is strictly **prohibited**.
- **Any negative remarks directed to the umpire will not be tolerated and will result in consequences, such as match or league ban.**
- **Umpire’s decision is final.**

Sledging:

- If the Umpire feels that a batsman is being targeted by the fielding side unfairly; the Umpire has the right to complain to the captain with a warning.
- If the player persists with his behaviour, then the same penalty applies as mentioned in “**point 41 above**”.
- **Spectators are not allowed to sledge anyone on the field.** They can support their teams on the field.
- If the Umpire feels that any of the spectators is sledging the player(s) on the field, he can give a warning to the captain of the team being supported by those spectators.
- Players on the field have the right to complain to the Umpire, if they feel that the Spectators are sledging them in a way that it is affecting their game.

- If the Spectator does not abide by the warnings – it is the responsibility of the team being supported by that Spectator to advise him / her to leave the vicinity / ground.

Umpire Fees:

- Umpire's fee is included in the membership fee charged to the clubs.
- Umpire's fee will be paid out to the umpire by the LCL board directly.

Insurance:

- All London games are insured by the city and insurance has been acquired by the LCL board.
 - This does not cover personal insurance outside the game time.
 - Acquiring insurance for the practice sessions/other games outside the league games are the clubs responsibility.
- If a club(s)/player(s) requires individual insurance, it is the club's own responsibility to do so on a timely manner.
- The league is not responsible for providing any insurance, the above points should be implemented in case of personal injuries, etc. refer to the point 54 for any insurance related inquiries.

Trophies

- MoM trophies will be awarded every game.
 - The player with the highest points on Cricclub from the winning team takes the MoM trophy.
 - It is the responsibility of the home team captain to hand over the trophy to the umpire for presentation every game.
- All other trophies mentioned below will be awarded during LCL AGM at the end of the season for both the Elite and Premier division.
 - Winner and Runner-Up
 - Best Batsman
 - Best Bowler
 - Best Fielder
 - MVP

Club Board Member Representation

- Board members are responsible for managing the league for the season. Any request from the Club regarding their representative is subject to Board approval.
 - Clubs who consider changing their representative at the LCL Board level should do so before the season commences or at the end of the season.